

Doe vs. Smith Case Summary

(Master Case Document — Updated July 2026)

1. Case Overview

This matter concerns the educational placement and services provided to **A.S.**, a minor student enrolled in the **North Ridge Public School District**. The parents (Plaintiffs) allege that the District failed to provide appropriate special-education services under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA), resulting in academic regression and emotional distress.

The District denies these allegations and asserts that all services were provided in accordance with the student's IEP and state guidelines.

2. Parties

- **Plaintiffs:** Jane and Robert Doe, parents of A.S.
- **Defendant:** North Ridge Public School District (Superintendent: Mark Smith)
- **Plaintiffs' Counsel:** John Smith
- **Defendant's Counsel:** Laura Benton, Benton & Associates

3. Procedural History (Last 6 Months)

- **January 12, 2026** — Parents submitted a formal request for an Independent Educational Evaluation (IEE). *(See: Correspondence/IEE_Request_01-12-26.pdf)*
- **February 3, 2026** — District denied the IEE request. *(Correspondence/District_Denial_Letter_02-03-26.pdf)*
- **February 20, 2026** — Plaintiffs filed a Due Process Complaint. *(Court Filings/Due_Process_Complaint_02-20-26.pdf)*
- **March 15, 2026** — District submitted its Response. *(Court Filings/District_Response_03-15-26.pdf)*
- **April 2026** — Initial disclosures exchanged. *(Records/Initial_Disclosures_04-01-26.pdf)*

- **May 2026** — Discovery opened; parties exchanged document requests.
(*Correspondence/Discovery_Requests_05-05-26.pdf*)
- **June 2026** — Expert evaluation completed by Dr. Helen Carter.
(*Evaluations/Carter_Evaluation_Report_06-18-26.pdf*)
- **July 2026** — Ongoing discovery; depositions scheduled for August.

4. Key Issues in Dispute

1. Whether the District failed to provide appropriate reading intervention services.
2. Whether the District ignored documented recommendations for occupational therapy.
3. Whether the student's IEP goals were measurable and reasonably calculated for progress.
4. Whether the District improperly denied the parents' request for an IEE.
5. Whether compensatory education is warranted.

5. Summary of Evidence (Discovery Phase)

A. Records Reviewed

- **Progress Monitoring Reports (2025–2026)**
(*Records/Progress_Reports_Collection.pdf*)
- **Teacher Emails Regarding Service Minutes**
(*Correspondence/Teacher_Emails_Service_Minutes.pdf*)
- **OT Screening Results** (*Records/OT_Screening_Results_03-2026.pdf*)

B. Evaluations

- **Independent Educational Evaluation (IEE)** Dr. Carter's June 2026 report identifies:
 - Significant reading fluency deficits
 - Fine-motor delays impacting writing
 - Inconsistent delivery of IEP-mandated services
 (*Evaluations/Carter_Evaluation_Report_06-18-26.pdf*)

C. Witness Statements

- **Classroom Teacher Statement (May 2026)** Notes inconsistent availability of intervention staff. (*Records/Teacher_Statement_05-2026.pdf*)

6. Timeline of Events (Last 6 Months)

- **Jan–Feb:** Dispute over IEE request
- **Feb–Mar:** Complaint filed; District response
- **Apr:** Initial disclosures
- **May–Jul:** Active discovery; document production
- **Aug (Scheduled):** Depositions of teacher, OT provider, and special-education coordinator

7. Current Case Status (July 2026)

- Discovery is ongoing.
- Plaintiffs are preparing deposition outlines.
- District has not yet produced complete service-minute logs.
- Expert report supports Plaintiffs' claims of inadequate services.
- Settlement discussions have not begun.

8. Outstanding Tasks

- Review District's July 2026 supplemental production.
- Prepare deposition questions for:
 - Classroom teacher
 - OT provider
 - Special-education coordinator
- Draft motion to compel missing service-minute logs.
- Summarize Dr. Carter's evaluation for hearing prep.
- Update this Master Case Document after August depositions.

9. Documents Referenced in This Summary

- [Correspondence/IEE_Request_01-12-26.pdf](#)

- [Correspondence/District_Denial_Letter_02-03-26.pdf](#)
- [Court Filings/Due Process Complaint 02-20-26.pdf](#)
- [Court Filings/District Response 03-15-26.pdf](#)
- [Records/Initial_Disclosures_04-01-26.pdf](#)
- [Correspondence/Discovery_Requests_05-05-26.pdf](#)
- [Evaluations/Carter_Evaluation_Report_06-18-26.pdf](#)
- [Records/Teacher Statement 05-2026.pdf](#)
- [Records/OT_Screening_Results_03-2026.pdf](#)